

The Interlopers

Saki (H. H. Munro) · 1919

First published: The Toys of Peace, 1919

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

AP edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Toys_of_Peace_and_Other_Papers/The_Interlopers (revision 4327290), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 7–10 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Interlopers suggest about feud and reconciliation?
- What does The Interlopers suggest about nature's power?
- What does The Interlopers suggest about irony of fate?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: AP

AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN

AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five

Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the

app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Interlopers	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*feud and reconciliation* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Interlopers

Author biography

Saki was the pen name of Hector Hugh Munro, born in Akyab, Burma (now Sittwe, Myanmar), on 18 December 1870. After his mother's death he was raised in Devon by strict aunts, a childhood that may lie behind his stories of clever children outwitting adults. He worked as a journalist and foreign correspondent and wrote witty, often cruel stories of Edwardian society. At 43 he enlisted as a private in the First World War and was killed by a sniper in France on 14 November 1916.

Historical and cultural context

Set in a forest in the Carpathian Mountains, the story reflects old feuds over land between aristocratic families. Saki was killed in action in the First World War in November 1916; the story was published after his death.

Publication and reception, then and now

Published posthumously in The Toys of Peace (1919).

Then: Popular.

Now: Taught for its twist ending and theme of reconciliation.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Two men, Ulrich von Gradwitz and Georg Znaeym, have feuded over a strip of forest for generations. On a stormy night they meet and are trapped under a fallen tree.

Main themes

- conflict and reconciliation.
- nature's power.
- irony.

Why it matters

It asks what feuds and inherited grudges are worth, and shows how quickly human quarrels shrink before forces larger than ourselves.

Spoilers · teacher only

They reconcile and call for help; figures approach, but they are wolves.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)

Before we open The Interlopers: Why do people hold grudges?
Prompt: Before we open The Interlopers: Why do people hold grudges?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

situational irony; conflict; twist ending.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Saki was the pen name of Hector Hugh Munro, born in Akyab, Burma (now Sittwe, Myanmar), on 18 December 1870. After his mother's death he was raised in Devon by strict aunts, a childhood that may lie behind his stories of clever children outwitting adults. He worked as a journalist and foreign correspondent and wrote witty, often cruel stories of Edwardian society. At 43 he enlisted as a private in the First World War and was killed by a sniper in France on 14 November 1916. The world of the book. Set in a forest in the Carpathian Mountains, the story reflects old feuds over land between aristocratic families. Saki was killed in action in the First World War in November 1916; the story was published after his death. Publication and reception. Published posthumously in The Toys of Peace (1919). Then: Popular. Now: Taught for its twist ending and theme of reconciliation.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40). The final word.

> *Wolves (The Interlopers, paragraph 40)*

Think-aloud: "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40). The final word.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): Two men, Ulrich von Gradwitz and Georg Znaeym, have feuded over a strip of forest for generations. On a stormy night they meet and are trapped under a fallen tree. Themes to track: conflict and reconciliation.: nature's power.: irony.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question.
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Interlopers: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does The Interlopers still matter? It asks what feuds and inherited grudges are worth, and shows how quickly human quarrels shrink before forces larger than ourselves.
Anchor question: Why might The Interlopers still be taught today?
Facilitation: It asks what feuds and inherited grudges are worth, and shows how quickly human quarrels shrink before forces larger than ourselves.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Who are the interlopers? Answer: Both men, or the wolves, or humans in nature's domain.
Exit ticket: Who are the interlopers?
Answer: Both men, or the wolves, or humans in nature's domain.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: The Interlopers.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Saki" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Saki); Saki, The Toys of Peace (1919) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Whether the story appeared in a newspaper before the 1919 collection is uncertain; cite the collection.

Lesson 2: The Interlopers

Focus: enemies reconciled too late

Content note (implied death by wolves): Sensitive content: Implied death by wolves. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes implied death by wolves.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

In a Carpathian forest on a stormy winter night, Ulrich von Gradwitz and Georg Znaeym, heirs to a generations-old land feud, meet while each hunts the other. A falling beech pins them both. Trapped, they make peace and plan to be friends, and shout for their men. Figures approach through the trees. Ulrich sees what they are: 'Wolves.'

Background: Published in 1919 in The Toys of Peace, after Saki's death in the First World War; the Carpathian borderlands changed hands repeatedly.

Significance: A compact model of situational irony; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What would it take for two people who hate each other to become friends? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to reconciliation because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes implied death by wolves.
Prompt: What would it take for two people who hate each other to become friends?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to reconciliation because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: they choose friendship.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: condolences — expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune; roebuck — a male roe deer; poaching — illegal hunting on someone else's land; foresters — men in charge of a forest and its game; mockingly — in a disrespectful jeering manner.
Words: condolences: expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune · roebuck: a male roe deer · poaching: illegal hunting on someone else's land · foresters: men in charge of a forest and its game · mockingly: in a disrespectful jeering manner

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1919 in The Toys of Peace, after Saki's death in the First World War; the Carpathian borderlands changed hands repeatedly. A compact model of situational irony; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans. Irony: The men finally make peace, plan to astonish the district with their friendship, and call for help, and the help that arrives is the wolves. The reconciliation comes just too late to matter. Conflict: The external conflict is man against man (the feud) until the falling beech turns it into man against nature, which reduces their quarrel to nothing. Setting: A storm-swept beech forest in the Carpathians on a winter night: the disputed land itself ends up trapping both men. Watch for the fallen beech: nature indifferent to human property lines; it pins both men equally.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40). The end. That is irony at work: The men finally make peace, plan to astonish the district with their friendship, and call for help, and the help that arrives is the wolves. The reconciliation comes just too late to matter.

> *Wolves* *(The Interlopers, paragraph 40)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40). The end. That is irony at work: The men finally make peace, plan to astonish the district with their friendship, and call for help, and the help that arrives is the wolves. The reconciliation comes just too late to matter.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Georg calls the forest "stolen" and gloats that it is "real justice," showing that even trapped and injured, the men still think in terms of the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to reconciliation? Expected: They choose friendship. (Hostility.)

> *Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest* *(The Interlopers, paragraph 6)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Georg calls the forest "stolen" and gloats that it is "real justice," showing that even trapped and injured, the men still think in terms of the feud.
Ask: How does this line connect to reconciliation?
Expected answer: They choose friendship. (Hostility.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for irony, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about enemies reconciled too late? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Interlopers develops the idea of enemies reconciled too late. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. When the text says "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. Georg mocks "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest," then Ulrich offers "I will ask you to be my friend," but the approaching figures are "Wolves."
Task: Annotate the story for irony, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about enemies reconciled too late? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Interlopers develops the idea of enemies reconciled too late. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. When the text says "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. Georg mocks "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest," then Ulrich offers "I will ask you to be my friend," but the approaching figures are "Wolves."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What would it take for two people who hate each other to become friends? Ask: is the ending fair?
Anchor question: What would it take for two people who hate each other to become friends?
Facilitation: Ask: is the ending fair?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about enemies reconciled too late? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. ("Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest", The Interlopers, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about enemies reconciled too late? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. ("Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest", The Interlopers, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes enemies reconciled too late. Key takeaway: they choose friendship.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The men finally make peace, plan to astonish the district with their friendship, and call for help, and the help that arrives is the wolves. The reconciliation comes just too late to matter.
- **Conflict:** The external conflict is man against man (the feud) until the falling beech turns it into man against nature, which reduces their quarrel to nothing.
- **Setting:** A storm-swept beech forest in the Carpathians on a winter night: the disputed land itself ends up trapping both men.

Themes and how they develop

- **reconciliation:** they choose friendship.

Symbols and motifs

- **the fallen beech:** nature indifferent to human property lines; it pins both men equally.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40) The end.
- "I will ask you to be my friend" (The Interlopers, paragraph 19) Reconciliation.
- "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6) Hostility.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature.
Evidence: "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6)
Reasoning: Georg mocks "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest," then Ulrich offers "I will ask you to be my friend," but the approaching figures are "Wolves."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
condolences (noun)	expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune	*For form's sake I shall send my condolences to your family."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
roebuck (noun)	a male roe deer	*The roebuck, which usually kept in the sheltered hollows during a storm-wind, were running like driven things to-night, and there was movement and unrest among the creatures that were wont to sleep through the dark hours.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
poaching (noun)	illegal hunting on someone else's land		

		"When my men come to release us you will wish, perhaps, that you were in a better plight than caught poaching on a neighbour's land, shame on you."	Student look-up (not yet verified)
foresters (noun)	men in charge of a forest and its game	*We fight this quarrel out to the death, you and I and our foresters, with no cursed interlopers to come between us.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mockingly (adverb)	in a disrespectful jeering manner	*And he laughed again, mockingly and savagely.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
splintered (verb)	broken into sharp pieces	*All round them lay a thick-strewn wreckage of splintered branches and broken twigs.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interlopers (noun)	people who intrude where they have no right	*We fight this quarrel out to the death, you and I and our foresters, with no cursed interlopers to come between us.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pestilential (adjective)	harmful, annoying, as if spreading disease	*"I heard nothing but the pestilential wind," said Georg hoarsely.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
undergrowth (noun)	low bushes and plants growing under trees	*"They won't carry far through the trees and undergrowth," said Georg, "but we can try.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What would it take for two people who hate each other to become friends?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with feud and reconciliation?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where is the story set? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: A forest on the eastern spurs of the Carpathians
2. Why do the families feud? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: Over a disputed strip of forest land
3. What traps the two men? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: A falling beech tree

4. What does Ulrich offer Georg? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.CHR] Look for: A drink from his wine flask and friendship
5. What is approaching at the end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: Wolves
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Interlopers" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: In a Carpathian forest on a stormy winter night, Ulrich von Gradwitz and Georg Znaeym, heirs to a generations-old land feud, meet while each hunts the other. A falling beech pins them both. Trapped, they make peace and plan to be friends, and shout for their men. Figures approach through the trees. Ulrich sees what they are: 'Wolves.'
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Interlopers"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.CHR] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Interlopers" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "For form's sake I shall send my condolences to your family."" What does "condolences" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: condolences: expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune.
10. Reread: "The roebuck, which usually kept in the sheltered hollows during a storm-wind, were running like driven things to-night, and there was movement and unrest among the creatures that were wont to sleep through the dark…" What does "roebuck" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: roebuck: a male roe deer.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Interlopers" suggest about enemies reconciled too late? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A compact model of situational irony; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.
2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the conflict in this story shape what we understand about enemies reconciled too late? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40): The end. On conflict: The external conflict is man against man (the feud) until the falling beech turns it into man against nature, which reduces their quarrel to nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "He strayed away by himself from the watchers whom he had placed in ambush on the crest of the hill, and wandered far down the steep slopes amid the wild tangle of undergrowth,…", why might Munro) have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "The Interlopers", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: In a Carpathian forest on a stormy winter night, Ulrich von Gradwitz and Georg Znaeym, heirs to a generations-old land feud, meet while each hunts the other. A falling beech pins them both. Trapped, they make peace and plan to be friends, and shout for their men. Figures approach through the trees.…

6. As the opening story, what does "The Interlopers" set up that the rest of The Interlopers will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "I will ask you to be my friend" (The Interlopers, paragraph 19): Reconciliation. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6): Hostility. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: "What would it take for two people who hate each other to become friends?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with feud and reconciliation? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40): The end. On setting: A storm-swept beech forest in the Carpathians on a winter night: the disputed land itself ends up trapping both men. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1919 in The Toys of Peace, after Saki's death in the First World War; the Carpathian borderlands changed hands repeatedly. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "I will ask you to be my friend" (The Interlopers, paragraph 19): Reconciliation. On setting: A storm-swept beech forest in the Carpathians on a winter night: the disputed land itself ends up trapping both men. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "A compact model of situational irony; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6): Hostility. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40): The end. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Interlopers" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about enemies reconciled too late? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "I will ask you to be my friend" (The Interlopers, paragraph 19): Reconciliation. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about "The Interlopers": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6): Hostility. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to nature's power: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Munro) need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40): The end. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "I will ask you to be my friend" (The Interlopers, paragraph 19): Reconciliation. On irony: The men finally make peace, plan to astonish the district with their friendship, and call for help, and the help that arrives is the wolves. The reconciliation comes just too late to matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how "The Interlopers" treats enemies reconciled too late with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Interlopers see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6): Hostility. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve feud and reconciliation? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Wolves" (The Interlopers, paragraph 40): The end. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about enemies reconciled too late? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "I will ask you to be my friend" (The Interlopers, paragraph 19): Reconciliation. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Saki (H. H. Munro) about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The twist shows that their feud was meaningless next to nature. Useful evidence: "Ulrich von Gradwitz snared in his stolen forest" (The Interlopers, paragraph 6): Hostility. Theme link: they choose friendship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Where is the story set?
   A. Siberia
   B. Scotland
   C. A forest on the eastern spurs of the Carpathians
   D. The Alps
2. Why do the families feud?
   A. Over a murder
   B. Over money
   C. Over a disputed strip of forest land
   D. Over a marriage
3. What traps the two men?
   A. An avalanche
   B. A flood
   C. A falling beech tree
   D. A bear trap

4. What does Ulrich offer Georg?
   A. His gun
   B. The land
   C. Money
   D. A drink from his wine flask and friendship
5. What is approaching at the end?
   A. A storm
   B. Rescuers with lanterns
   C. Their men
   D. Wolves
6. In the line “For form’s sake I shall send my condolences to your family.””, what does “condolences” most nearly mean?
   A. men in charge of a forest and its game
   B. a male roe deer
   C. expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune
   D. illegal hunting on someone else's land
7. In the line “The roebuck, which usually kept in the sheltered hollows during a storm-wind, were running like driven things to-night, and there was movement and unrest among the creatures that were wont to sleep through the dark hours.”, what does “roebuck” most nearly mean?
   A. men in charge of a forest and its game
   B. expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune
   C. illegal hunting on someone else's land
   D. a male roe deer

Answer key: 1. C (A forest on the eastern spurs of the Carpathians); 2. C (Over a disputed strip of forest land); 3. C (A falling beech tree); 4. D (A drink from his wine flask and friendship); 5. D (Wolves); 6. C (expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune); 7. D (a male roe deer)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; AP: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Interlopers,” how does Munro) show enemies reconciled too late? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; AP: see unit standards): In The Interlopers, how does Munro) develop the idea of enemies reconciled too late? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; AP: see unit standards): Analyze how The Interlopers develops the idea of enemies reconciled too late. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; AP: see unit standards): Analyze how the structure of The Interlopers (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of enemies reconciled too late. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Two readers disagree about what The Interlopers suggests about enemies reconciled too late. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Saki (H. H. Munro) uses irony in The Interlopers to complicate the reader's understanding of enemies reconciled too late. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Situate The Interlopers within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of enemies reconciled too late responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; AP: see unit standards): Read The Interlopers alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of enemies reconciled too late follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; AP: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Interlopers and its treatment of enemies reconciled too late. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; AP: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Interlopers as evidence for a larger claim about enemies reconciled too late in The Interlopers. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; AP: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Interlopers as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of enemies reconciled too late. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Interlopers.

SAT-style questions

1. *"When my men come to release us you will wish, perhaps, that you were in a better plight than caught poaching on a neighbour's land, shame on you."*

As used in the text, what does the word "poaching" most nearly mean?

A. people who intrude where they have no right

B. low bushes and plants growing under trees

C. illegal hunting on someone else's land

D. harmful, annoying, as if spreading disease

2. *He strayed away by himself from the watchers whom he had placed in ambush on the crest of the hill, and wandered far down the steep slopes amid the wild tangle of undergrowth, peering through the tree trunks and listening through the whistling and skirling of the wind and the restless beating of the branches for sight and sound of the marauders. If only on this wild night, in this dark, lone spot, he might come across Georg Znaeym, man to man, with none to witness—that was the wish that was uppermost in his thoughts. And as he stepped round the trunk of a huge beech he came face to face with the man he sought.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Interlopers"?

A. Enemies reconciled too late

B. Guilt that the mind cannot hide

C. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

D. Brotherhood against an indifferent sea

SAT key: 1. C (illegal hunting on someone else's land); 2. A (Enemies reconciled too late)

Whole-book test

The Interlopers: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where is the story set?
   A. Siberia
   B. Scotland
   C. A forest on the eastern spurs of the Carpathians
   D. The Alps
2. Why do the families feud?
   A. Over a murder
   B. Over money
   C. Over a disputed strip of forest land
   D. Over a marriage
3. What traps the two men?
   A. An avalanche
   B. A flood
   C. A falling beech tree
   D. A bear trap
4. What does Ulrich offer Georg?
   A. His gun
   B. The land
   C. Money
   D. A drink from his wine flask and friendship
5. What is approaching at the end?
   A. A storm
   B. Rescuers with lanterns
   C. Their men
   D. Wolves
6. In the line “For form’s sake I shall send my condolences to your family.””, what does “condolences” most nearly mean?
   A. men in charge of a forest and its game
   B. a male roe deer
   C. expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune
   D. illegal hunting on someone else's land

7. In the line “The roebuck, which usually kept in the sheltered hollows during a storm-wind, were running like driven things to-night, and there was movement and unrest among the creatures that were wont to sleep through the dark hours.”, what does “roebuck” most nearly mean?
   A. men in charge of a forest and its game
   B. expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune
   C. illegal hunting on someone else's land
   D. a male roe deer
8. As used in the story (“For form’s sake I shall send my condolences to your family.””), what does “condolences” mean?
   A. expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune
   B. in a disrespectful jeering manner
   C. harmful, annoying, as if spreading disease
   D. illegal hunting on someone else's land
9. As used in the story (“The roebuck, which usually kept in the sheltered hollows during a storm-wind, were running like driven things to-night, and there was moveme”), what does “roebuck” mean?
   A. broken into sharp pieces
   B. a male roe deer
   C. low bushes and plants growing under trees
   D. men in charge of a forest and its game
10. As used in the story (““When my men come to release us you will wish, perhaps, that you were in a better plight than caught poaching on a neighbour’s land, shame o”), what does “poaching” mean?
    A. people who intrude where they have no right
    B. expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune
    C. illegal hunting on someone else's land
    D. in a disrespectful jeering manner
11. As used in the story (“We fight this quarrel out to the death, you and I and our foresters, with no cursed interlopers to come between us.”), what does “foresters” mean?
    A. harmful, annoying, as if spreading disease
    B. a male roe deer
    C. broken into sharp pieces
    D. men in charge of a forest and its game
12. As used in the story (“And he laughed again, mockingly and savagely.”), what does “mockingly” mean?
    A. in a disrespectful jeering manner
    B. low bushes and plants growing under trees
    C. illegal hunting on someone else's land
    D. people who intrude where they have no right

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how feud and reconciliation develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
2. Explain how nature's power develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how irony of fate develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (feud and reconciliation, nature's power, irony of fate) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. C (A forest on the eastern spurs of the Carpathians); 2. C (Over a disputed strip of forest land); 3. C (A falling beech tree); 4. D (A drink from his wine flask and friendship); 5. D (Wolves); 6. C (expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune); 7. D (a male roe deer); 8. A (expressions of sympathy for someone's misfortune); 9. B (a male roe deer); 10. C (illegal hunting on someone else's land); 11. D (men in charge of a forest and its game); 12. A (in a disrespectful jeering manner)

Essay assignments

Essay: Feud and reconciliation

Middle School (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Interlopers teaches about feud and reconciliation. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Saki (H. H. Munro) develops feud and reconciliation in The Interlopers. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Saki (H. H. Munro) develops feud and reconciliation across The Interlopers. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Interlopers (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of feud and reconciliation. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of feud and reconciliation in The Interlopers. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Saki (H. H. Munro)'s choices in The Interlopers (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of feud and reconciliation, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Interlopers's treatment of feud and reconciliation in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on feud and reconciliation in The Interlopers that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on feud and reconciliation in The Interlopers. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about feud and reconciliation in The Interlopers, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on feud and reconciliation in The Interlopers, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Nature's power

Middle School (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Interlopers teaches about nature's power. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Saki (H. H. Munro) develops nature's power in The Interlopers. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Saki (H. H. Munro) develops nature's power across The Interlopers. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Interlopers (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature's power. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature's power in The Interlopers. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Saki (H. H. Munro)'s choices in The Interlopers (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of nature's power, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Interlopers's treatment of nature's power in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature's power in The Interlopers that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on nature's power in The Interlopers. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about nature's power in The Interlopers, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature's power in The Interlopers, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Irony of fate

Middle School (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Interlopers teaches about irony of fate. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Saki (H. H. Munro) develops irony of fate in The Interlopers. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Saki (H. H. Munro) develops irony of fate across The Interlopers. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Interlopers (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of irony of fate. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of irony of fate in The Interlopers. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Saki (H. H. Munro)'s choices in The Interlopers (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of irony of fate, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Interlopers's treatment of irony of fate in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on irony of fate in The Interlopers that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on irony of fate in The Interlopers. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about irony of fate in The Interlopers, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on irony of fate in The Interlopers, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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